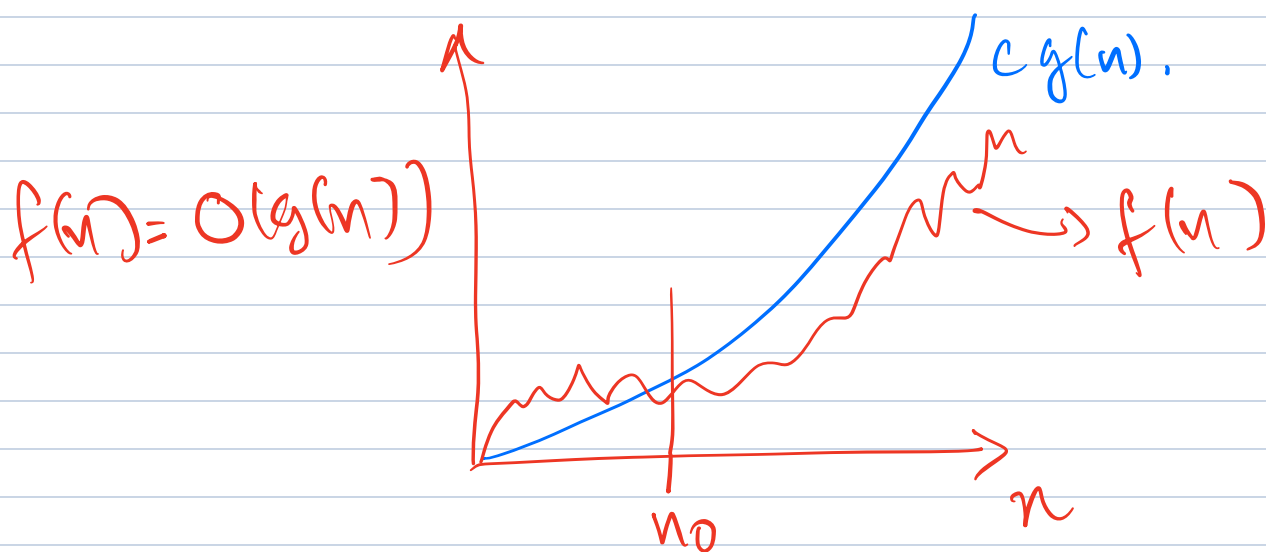


ID 2230 Data Structures and Applications

Big O notation

Typically algorithms' performance is measured using Θ notation or O notation

$O(g(n)) = \{f(n) : \text{there exists } c, n_0 \text{ such that } 0 \leq f(n) \leq cg(n) \text{ for all } n \geq n_0\}.$

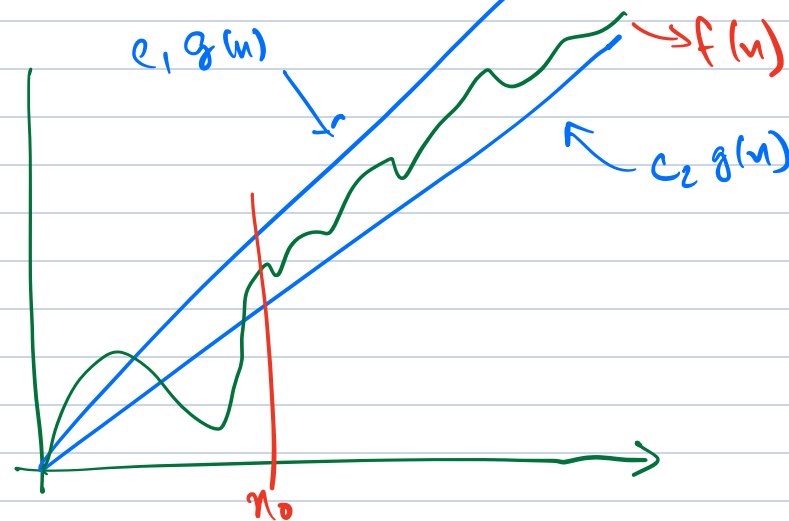


Q: Say $g_1(n) \geq g(n)$, and $f(n) = O(g(n))$ does it follow that $f(n) = O(g_1(n))$ also?

A: YES: same n_0 and c would suffice

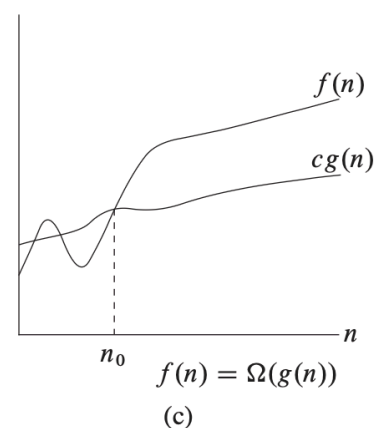
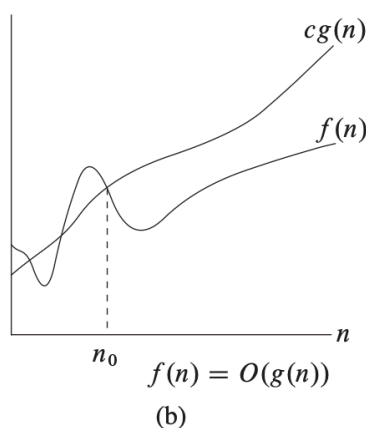
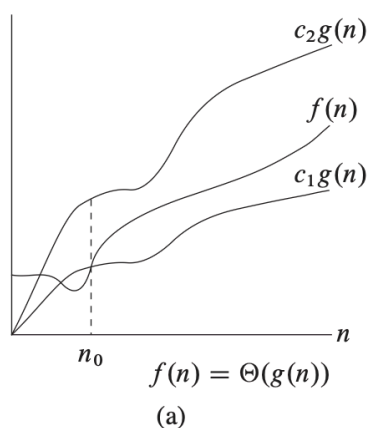
Ω notation: $f(n) = \Omega(g(n))$ if there is a c and n_0 such that for $n \geq n_0$, $f(n) \geq c g(n)$.

Θ notation: $f(n) = \Theta(g(n))$ if there exist $c_1 > c_2 > 0$ and n_0 such that for $n \geq n_0$, $c_1 g(n) \geq f(n) \geq c_2 g(n)$.



Review: Θ notation $\rightarrow$ Chap 3

O , Θ , Ω , o , ω



From CLRS (Chapter 3).

$$f(n) = n^2 + 2n + 5$$

$$f(n) = O(n^2).$$

For all $n > \underbrace{4}_{n_0}$, $f(n) \leq \underbrace{2}_c n^2$.

$$\underbrace{n^2 + 2n + 5}_{29} \leq \underbrace{2n^2}_{32} \text{ for } n \geq 4$$

$$n = 4$$

$$n = 5$$

$$40$$

$$50$$

$$f(n) = 3n^2 + 3n + 100$$

Is $3n^2 + 3n + 100 = O(n^2)$? YES.

$$n_0 = \underline{10}.$$

$$c = 10.$$

$$3n^2 + 3n + 100 \leq 10 \cdot n^2.$$

$$f(n) = 3n^2 + 3n + 100$$

$$f(n) = \Theta(n^2)$$

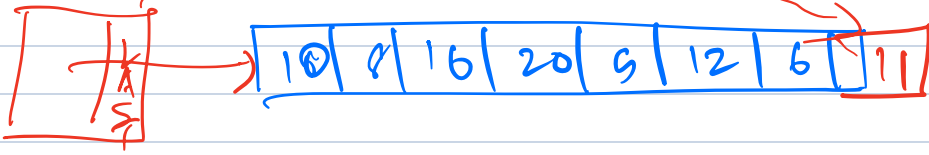
$$\text{For All } n \geq \underbrace{0}_{n_0}, \quad 3n^2 + 3n + 100 \geq \underbrace{1}_{C_2 \text{ Const}} n^2$$

$$\text{For all } n \geq 10, \quad \underbrace{1 \cdot n^2 \leq 3n^2 + 3n + 100 \leq 10 \cdot n^2}_{\text{Verify it!}}$$

Searching / Sorting

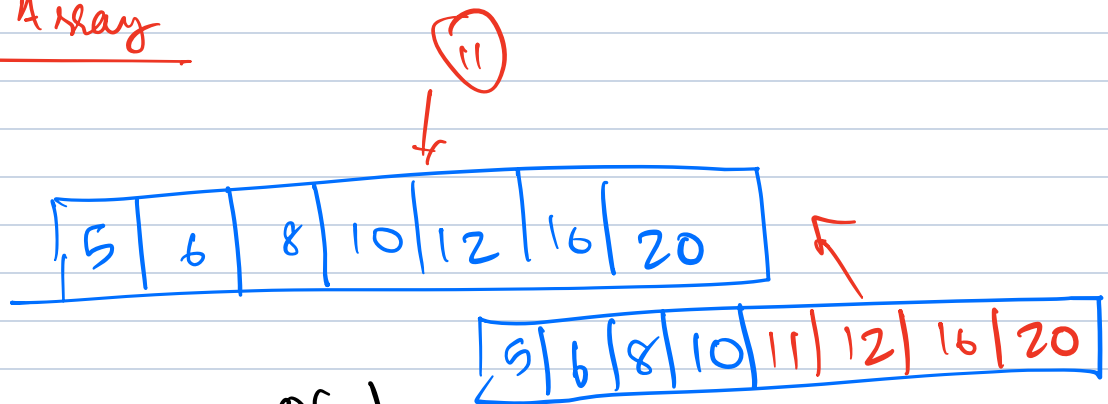
- Suppose we want to store data / organize data in such a way that it is easy to search, insert / delete / modify.
- Say your bank records, airport traffic system, many applications.
- What are the ways?

Unsorted Array



- Easy to insert → Easy - Add at the end : $O(1)$.
- Searching ? → $O(n)$ - One may have to go through all records.
- Deleting → Can take $O(n)$ time because we need to search.
- Editing → Easy after you locate the element.

Sorted Array



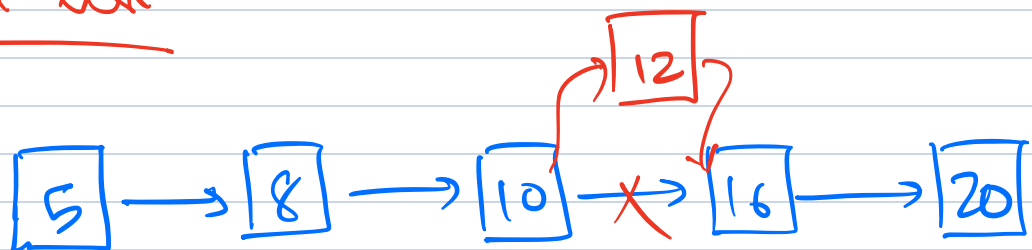
- Insertion → $O(n)$. We may have to shift $\Sigma(n)$ elements to make space.
- Delete → $O(n)$. We may have to shift + $\Sigma(n)$ elements to fill up the gap.
- Edit
- Search ? → If we are changing the key, we may need $\Sigma(n)$ time.
→ BINARY SEARCH. → $O(\log n)$.

Unsorted list



- Insert : $O(1)$, once you find the tail.
- Delete : Search time + $O(1)$
- Search : $O(n)$
- Edit : Search time + $O(1)$.

Sorted list



- Insert : Search + $O(1)$.
- Search : $O(n)$. We cannot do binary search.
- Delete : Search + $O(1)$.
- Edit : Search + Re-insert.

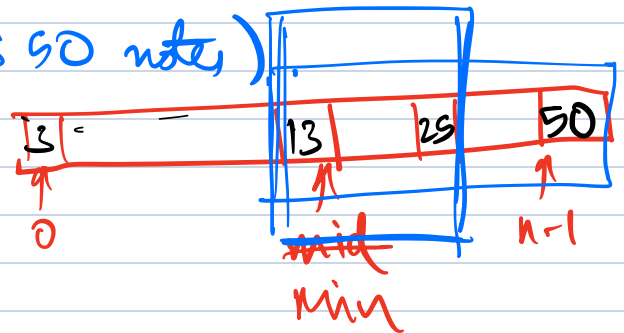
Binary Search

Faster Search in a sorted array.

number being searched

- 1 set min = 0 and max = n - 1
- 2 find middle of array $\rightarrow \left[\frac{\text{min} + \text{max}}{2} \right]$
- 3 if k is less than array[middle]
- 4 set max to middle - 1
- 5 go to line 2
- 6 else if k is greater than array[middle]
- 7 set min to middle + 1
- 8 go to line 2
- 9 else if k is equal to array[middle]
- 10 you found k in the array!
- 11 else
- 12 k is not in the array

(From Harvard CS 90 notes)
Courtesy.



Complexity.

In every step, the search space is cut down by half. So how many times can we divide n by 2, till we get an array of size 1 or 2?

$O(\log n)$ times $\leftarrow \leq \log_2 n$ times.

let A be the array and k be the key that is being searched.

$\text{BIN-SEARCH}(A, \text{min}, \text{max}, k)$

~~Set $\text{min} = 0$ and $\text{max} = n-1$~~

If either $A[\text{min}] = k$ or $A[\text{max}] = k$,
then return the correct entry

Else If $\text{max} \leq \text{min} + 1$, then return
"key not present"

$$\text{mid} = \lfloor (\text{min} + \text{max}) / 2 \rfloor$$

If $A[\text{mid}] < k$, then call

$\text{BIN-SEARCH}(A, \text{mid} + 1, \text{max}, k)$

If $A[\text{mid}] > k$, then call

$\text{BIN-SEARCH}(A, \text{min}, \text{mid} - 1, k)$

This takes $O(\log n)$ time.

In every step, we are reducing the search space by half.

$$\log_2 n = \log_e n * \log_2 e$$

$$\log_2 n = \log_{10} n * \log_2 10$$

$$O(\log n)$$

Sorting

Input: Given an array, A with values that are not sorted

Output: Return the same values sorted in ascending order.

Bubble Sort.

10 8 16 20 5 12.

loop 1.

8 10 16 20 5 12

8 10 16 20 5 12

8 10 16 20 5 12

8 10 16 5 20 12

8 10 16 5 12 20

After loop 1, the largest element will be at the end.

loop 2

8 10 16 5 12 20

8 10 16 5 12 20

8 10 16 5 12 20

8 10 5 16 12 20

8 10 5 12 16 20

Second largest is at the second last position

loop 3

8 10 9 12 16 20

8 10 9 12 16 20

8 9 10 12 16 20

8 9 10 12 16 20

12

loop 4

8 9 10 12 16 20

5 8 10 12 16 20

5 8 10 12 16 20

10

loop 5

5 8 10 12 16 20

5 8 10 12 16 20

Bubble sort (A). $\rightarrow$ indexed from 1 to n

For $k = 1$ to $n-1$

For $j = 1$ to $n-k$.

If $A[j] > A[j+1]$

Swap $A[j] \neq A[j+1]$.

Why is this correct?

At the end of loop k , the k largest elements occupy the last k positions of the array in the correct relative ordering.

At the end of loop $k = n-1$, all the elements are in the correct order.

Time Complexity:

Outside loop runs $n-1$ times.

Each outside loop calls the inside loop $n-k$ times $\leq n$ times

Each iteration of the inside loop is a comparison plus possibly a swap, $\rightarrow$ $O(1)$ time.

$$\text{Total time} \leq n-1 * n * O(1)$$

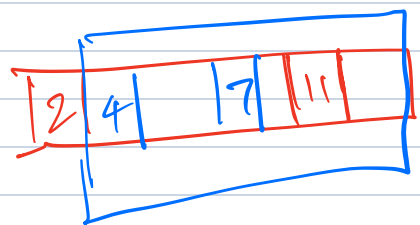
Instead of time, another measure of complexity used is the no. of comparisons.

$$= \underline{O(n^2)}$$

Other sorting algorithms.

- Selection Sort
- Merge Sort ✓
- Quick Sort. ✓
- Heap Sort → After heap.
- Insertion Sort.
- Radix Sort.
- Counting Sort. → n is large but range is small
- Shell Sort.

27 / Aug / 2026



$O(n^2)$ { → Selection sort: Find smallest element and swap with the first

→ Insertion sort: Repeatedly insert the next element into the sorted

list

[7 | 3 8 6 2]

↓

[3 7 | 8 6 2]

↓

[3 7 8 | 6 2]

↓

[3 6 7 8 | 2]

↓

[2 3 6 7 8]

Also $O(n^2)$
running time in
worst case.

→ Counting Sort: Say you have
bounded range. This part is crucial.

[1 2 1 3 1 2 1 1 3 1 2]

↓

[1 1 1 1 1 1 2 2 2 3 3]

$O(n+k)$

where

k is the range

k is the size of the range.

Counting Sort (input, k).

Assuming the range is $1, 2, 3 \dots k$

Count $\leftarrow$ Array of k zeros.

Output $\leftarrow$ Array of same length as input

For $i = 1$ to length (input)

If $j == \text{input}[i]$

Count [j] = Count [j] + 1.

Temp = 1

For $i = 1$ to k

For $j = 1$ to Count [i]

Output [Temp] = i

Temp = Temp + 1

Return Output

Counting Sort and Radix Sort are NOT

COMPARISON-BASED Sorting Algorithms. In

Comparison-based algorithms, you see only

→ Radix Sort : ^{allowed to compare two} input numbers.

Digit by digit sort starting from least significant digit.

91 19 55 54 37.

→ 91 54 55 37 19

→ 19 37 54 55 91

Merge Sort

Input : An array of numbers $A[1, 2, \dots, n]$

Output : A sorted version of this array

If $n > 1$

Return Merge [MergeSort $A[1, \dots, \lfloor \frac{n}{2} \rfloor]$,
MergeSort $A(\lfloor \frac{n}{2} \rfloor + 1, \dots, n)$]

Else

Return A . Each individually sorted.

Merge $X[1, \dots, k]$ $Y[1, \dots, l]$

If $k=0$, return $Y[1, \dots, l]$

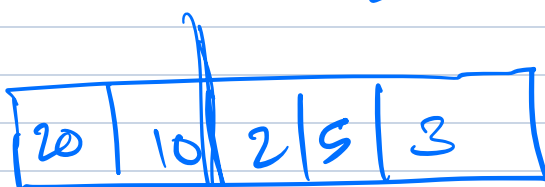
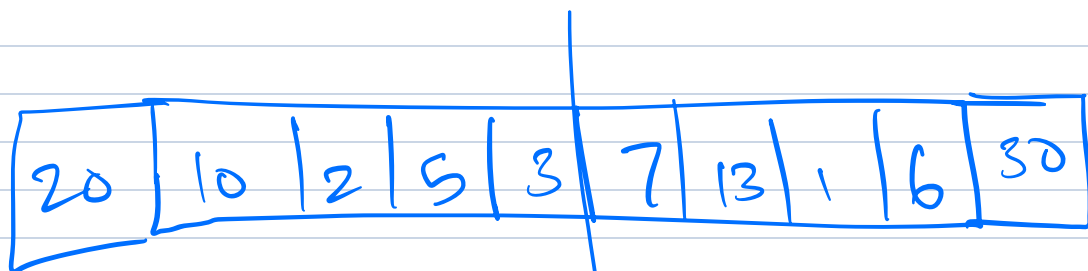
If $l=0$, return $X[1, \dots, k]$

If $X[1] \leq Y[1]$

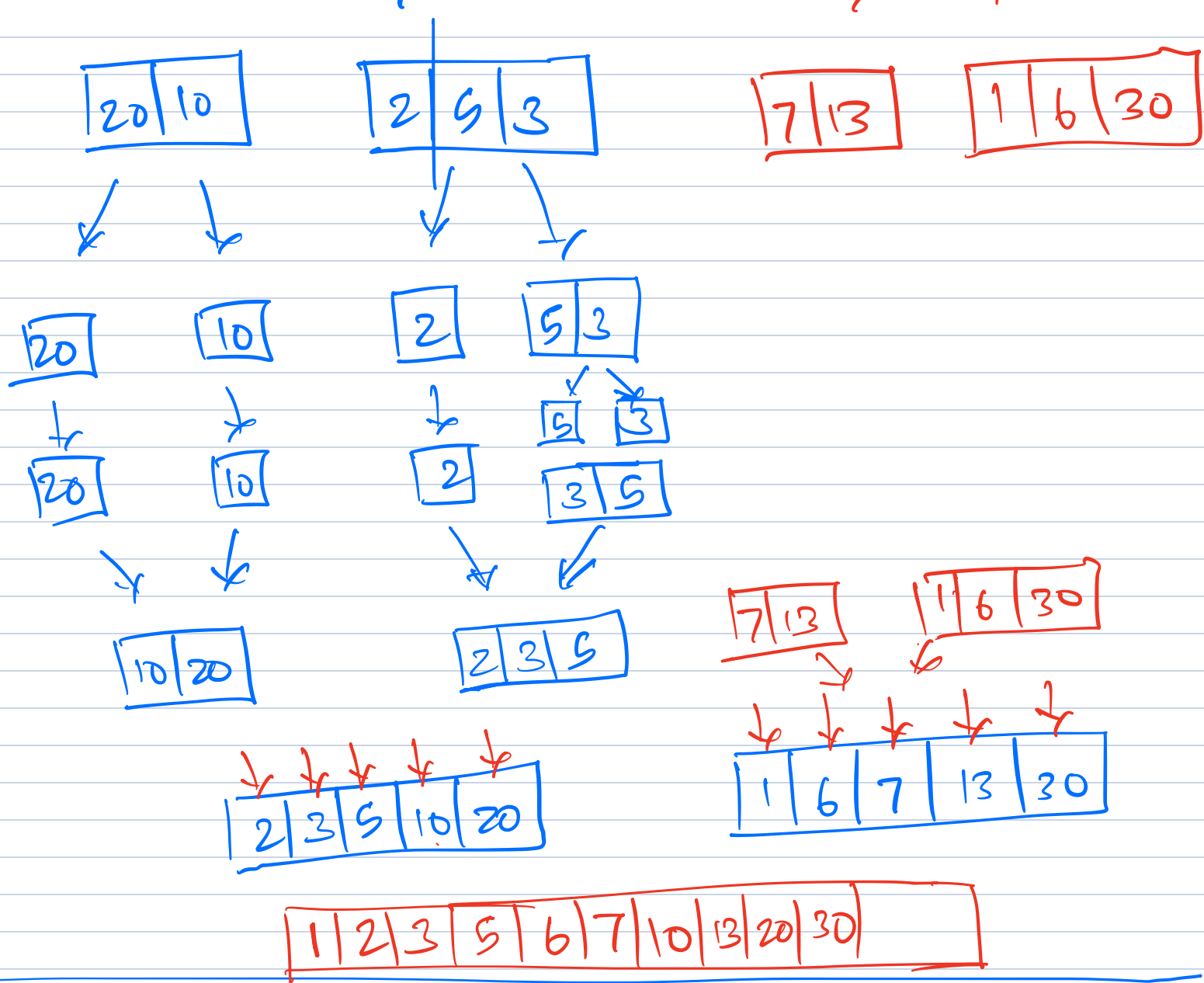
Return $X[1], [\text{Merge}[X[2, \dots, k], Y[1, \dots, l]]]$

Else

Return $Y[1], [\text{Merge}[X[1, \dots, k], Y[2, \dots, l]]]$



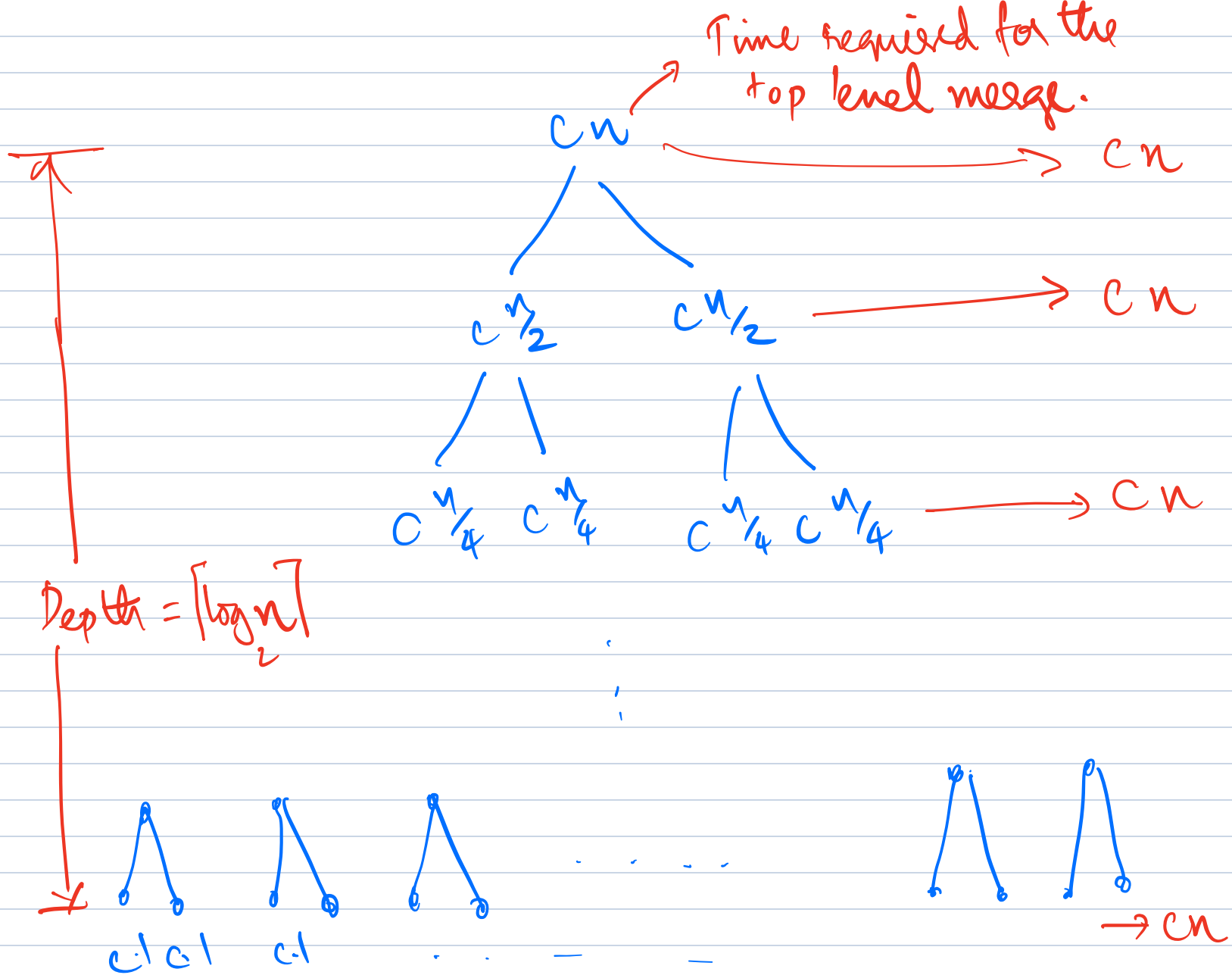
Merging takes $O(n)$



Running time for Merge : $O(k+l)$

Overall time taken for Merge sort. Let $T(n)$ represent time to solve instance of size n .

Recurrence Relation $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} T(n) = 2T(n/2) + O(n). \\ \Rightarrow O(n \log n) \end{array} \right.$



So the total time = effort at each level
 $\times$
 No. of levels

ALGORITHMS

BY PAPADIMITRIOU

DASGUPTA

VAZIRANI

$$= cn \times \log n$$

$$= cn \log n$$

$$= O(n \log n)$$

Master Theorem : If $T(n) = a T(\frac{n}{b}) + O(n^d)$

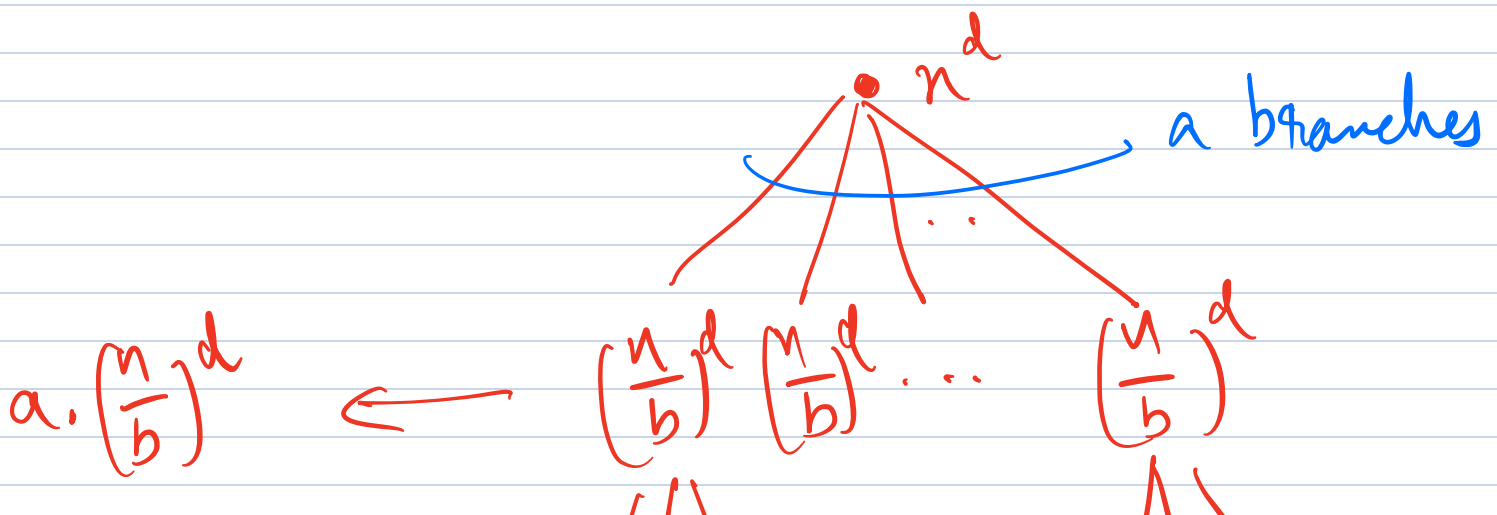
for $a > 0$, $b > 1$, $d \geq 0$, then

$$T(n) = \begin{cases} O(n^d) & \text{if } d > \log_b a \quad (\text{OR } b^d > a) \\ O(n^d \log n) & \text{if } d = \log_b a \quad (\text{OR } b^d = a) \\ O(n^{\log_b a}) & \text{if } d < \log_b a \quad (\text{OR } b^d < a) \end{cases}$$

Reason: Total work at k^{th} level.

$$a^k * O\left(\frac{n}{b^k}\right)^d = O(n^d) \cdot \left(\frac{a}{b^d}\right)^k$$

$$\frac{a}{b^d} < 1 \iff d > \log_b a :$$



$$a^2 \left(\frac{n}{b^2}\right)^d$$

If $a < b^d$, then the top part dominates $\rightarrow T(n) = O(n^d)$

If $a = b^d$, then each level contributes equally. And total $\log_b n$ - levels

$$T(n) = O(n^d \log_b n)$$

If $a > b^d$, then bottom part dominates

$$T(n) = O(n^{\log_b a})$$

QUICKSORT

QUICKSORT (A, l, n).

If $n \leq 1$, return A .

Choose a pivot p (or equivalently an index k from l to n)

For example, one way could be to choose the first element, i.e., $A[l]$ to be the pivot.

Then Partition A w.r.t to the pivot p .

Order the elements in A as

Smaller than p , p , larger than p .

Say p is now in index l .

Then recursively sort left and right parts using QUICKSORT ($A, l, l-1$) and QUICKSORT ($A, l+1, n$)

Return A.

2	5	3	1	6	7	20	10	13	30
---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----

20	10	2	5	3	7	13	1	6	30
----	----	---	---	---	---	----	---	---	----

First pivot = 20.

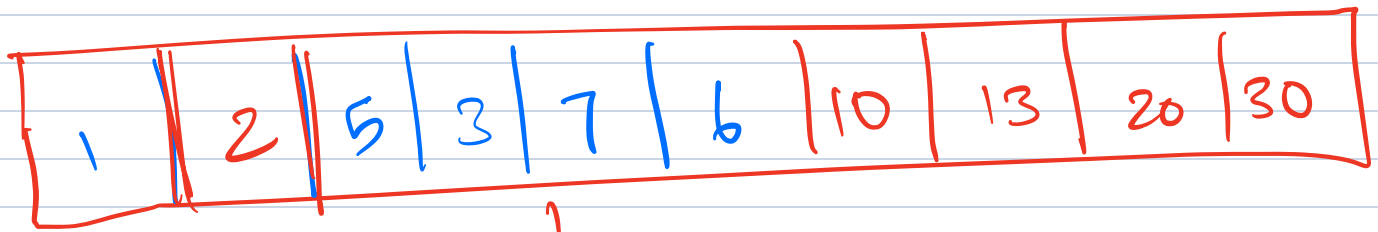
10	2	5	3	7	13	1	6	20	30
----	---	---	---	---	----	---	---	----	----

Second pivot = 10

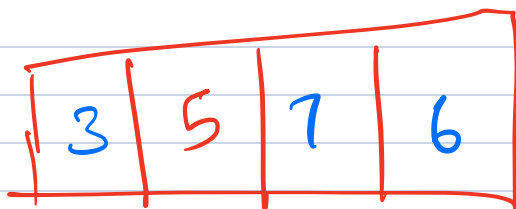
Note: After the partition operation, the pivot will be at the correctly sorted position.

2	5	3	7	1	6	10	13	20	30
---	---	---	---	---	---	----	----	----	----

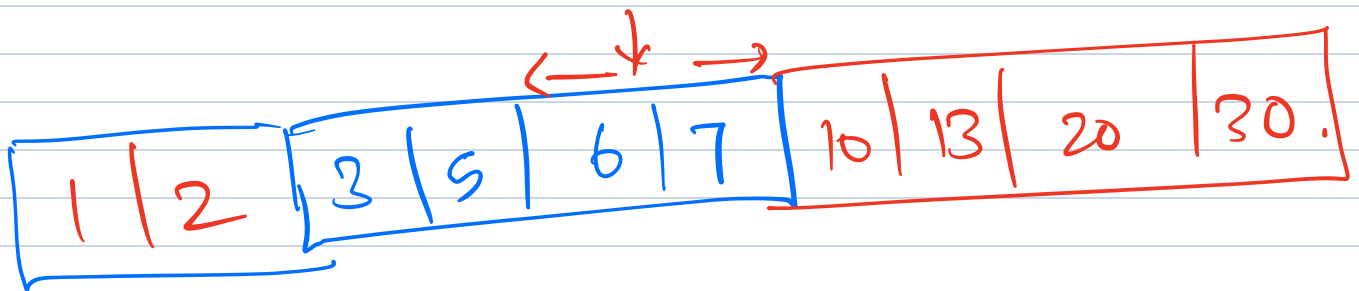
For the left part, pivot = 2.



↓
Pivot = 5



↘ Pivot = 7



EXERCISE: Think of what happens when the

input array is $[1, 2, 3, \dots, n]$ in the sorted order. And pivot rule is the first element.

↳ Running time = $O(n^2)$
↳ Space complexity = $O(n^2)$



QUICKSORT (A, p, r)
(From CLRS)

If $p < r$

$q = \text{PARTITION}(A, p, r)$

$\text{QUICKSORT}(A, p, q-1)$

$\text{QUICKSORT}(A, q+1, r)$

→ $\text{PARTITION}(\cdot)$
returns q
which is the
index of the
pivot.

To sort the entire array, we need to make
 $\text{QUICKSORT}(A, l, n)$ as the top level call.

$\text{PARTITION}(A, p, r)$

$x = A[r] \rightarrow \text{Pivot}$

$i = p - 1$

For $j = p$ to $r-1$

If $A[j] \leq x,$

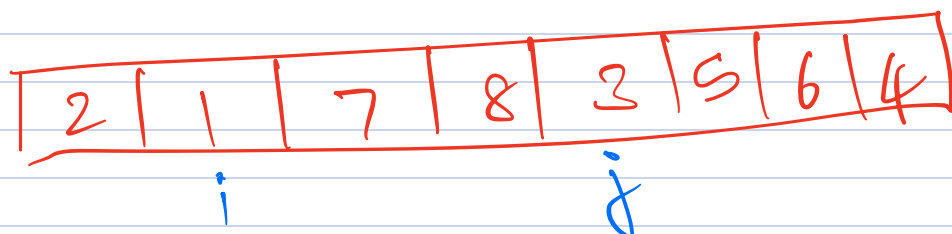
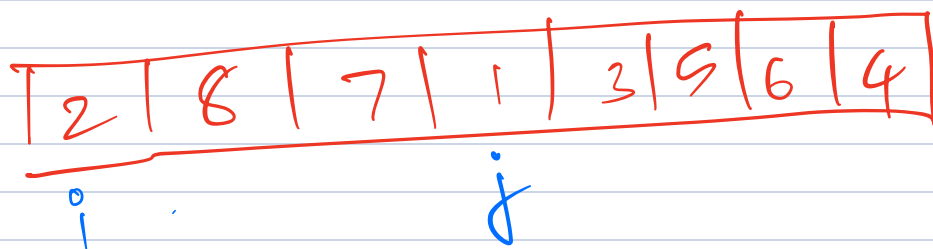
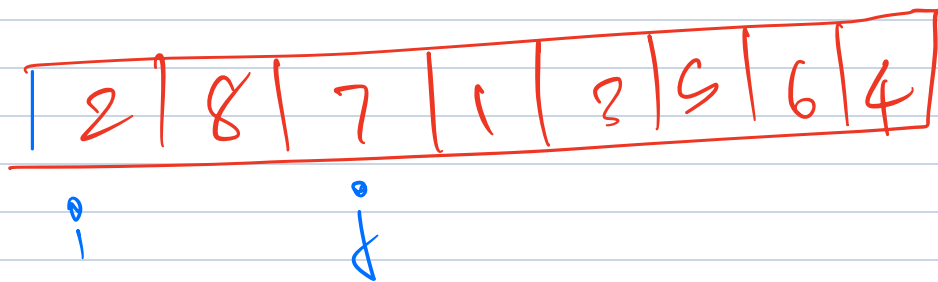
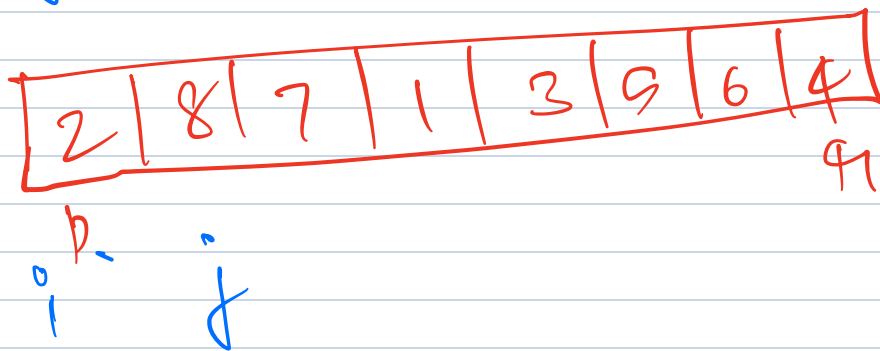
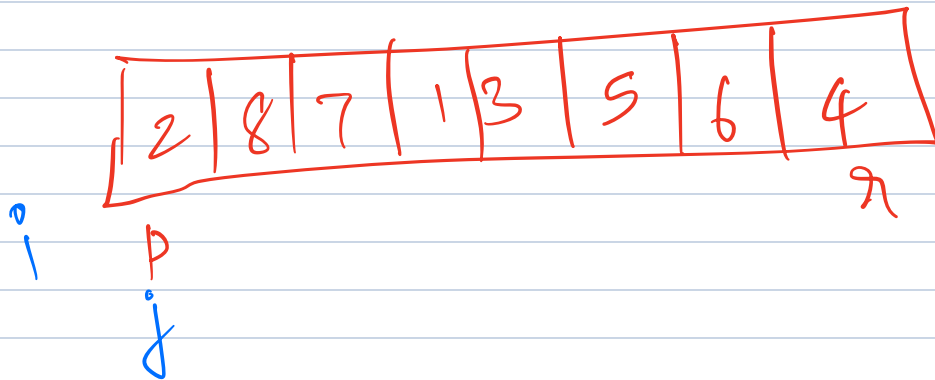
$i = i + 1$

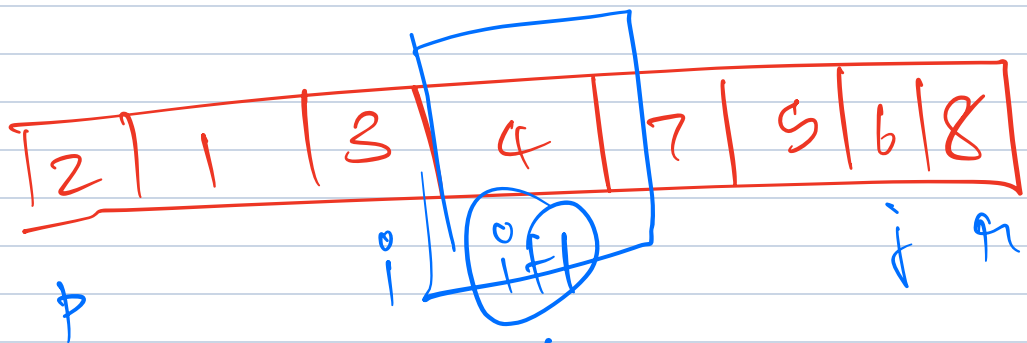
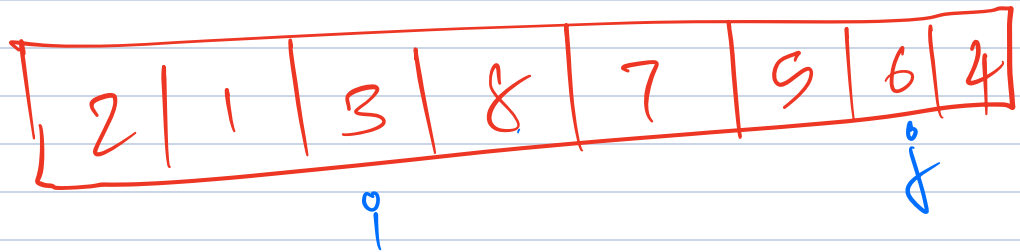
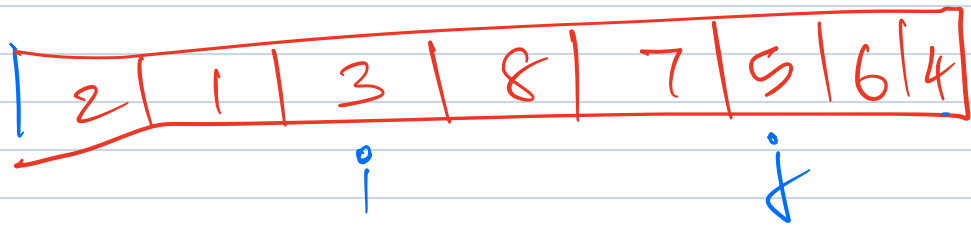
Exchange $A[i]$ with $A[j]$

Pivot here is
the last element
 $A[r]$

Exchange $A[i+1]$ with $A[n]$

Return $i+1$





Return